

LESSON 10: THE PASSIVE VOICE

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–9

Lesson 9 introduced the **imperative** (direct commands), the **infinitive** (verbal noun / maṣdar), and the **l- + infinitive construction** for expressing purpose, ability, desire, and obligation. Before proceeding, confirm you can recall the following:

- **Imperative formation:** Peal msg = CCoC; fsG = CCoC+ī; mpl = CCoC+w; fpl = CCoC+ān
- **Negative commands:** lā + imperfect (never imperative)
- **Infinitive:** Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCāCāCū; Aphel = 'aCCāCū
- **Semi-modals:** šarī, yākel, bā ' ē, šābē, paqed, šadar — all govern l- + infinitive

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	Give the Peal imperative .msg of ' -z-l (go)	'ezal — go!	ܐܝܠ
2	How do you say 'Do not ?kill!' (m.pl.)	lā teqtlūn	ܠܐ ܬܩܬܠܘܢ
3	What is the Peal ?infinitive of q-t-l (kill)	meqtal	ܡܩܬܠ
4	-Translate: šarī l .mešma '.	He began to hear.	ܫܪܝ ܠܡܫܡܐ
5	What does pūqdānā ?mean	commandment, command (noun from p- q-d)	ܩܕܫܐ

SECTION 2: THE PASSIVE/REFLEXIVE STEMS — OVERVIEW

2.1 The Principle of Passive Formation in Syriac

In Syriac, the passive voice is not expressed by auxiliary verbs (as in English: 'is killed', 'was written') but by a separate, **inflected stem** built from the active stem by means of a characteristic prefix: ' **Et-** or **Et-**. These are called the **Et-stems**. Each active stem has a corresponding Et-stem that functions as its passive or reflexive counterpart.

Students of Hebrew will recognise an analogy with the **Niphal** (נִפְעַל, passive of Qal) and **Hitpael** (הִתְפַּעֵל, reflexive of Piel). Arabists will recognise the parallel with **Forms V, VI, VII, and VIII**: the tā ' -prefixed (تَفَعَّلَ) and n-prefixed (انْفَعَلَ) passives/reflexives. In Greek, the same **passive voice** forms (e.g., παίδεύομαι) serve the function. Latin uses separate passive endings (-or, -ris, -tur etc.).

2.2 The Three Et-Stems

ET-STEM NAME	ACTIVE COUNTERPART	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Ethpeel ܐܬܦܥܠ	Peal	'et-	Passive or reflexive of Peal: 'to be killed', 'to wash oneself'
Etpaael ܐܬܦܥܠ	Paael	'etpa-	Passive or reflexive of Paael: 'to be blessed', 'to be sanctified'
Ettaphal ܐܬܦܥܠ	Aphel	'etta-	Passive of Aphel (causative): 'to be saved', 'to be sent'

+-----+

Cross-Linguistic Summary: Passive Formation |

|

Syriac Ethpeel: 'et- + Peal root → parallel to Hebrew Niphal / |

Hitpael |

|

Syriac Etpaael: 'etpa- + Paael → parallel to Arabic Form V تَفَعَّلَ |

|

Syriac Ettaphal: 'etta- + Aphel → parallel to Arabic Form VII **إِنْفَعَلَ** |

|

Greek: active + passive endings (same paradigm structure, different | endings) |

|

Latin: active vs. passive endings (-o/-or, -s/-ris, -t/-tur etc.) |

+-----+

SECTION 3: THE ETHPEEL STEM

3.1 Formation of the Ethpeel

The Ethpeel is formed by prefixing 'et- to the Peal root. The perfect stem is 'etCCeC. The participial form, which is very common, is metCCeC. In texts, the prefix may appear as 'et- or 'it- depending on dialect and vowelling.

Example: Root q-t-l (kill) → Ethpeel perfect: 'etqtel ܩܬܠܐ 'he was killed'; Participle: metqtel ܩܬܠܐ 'being killed'

3.2 Phonological Rules — Assimilation and Metathesis

When the Peal root begins with certain consonants, the t of the 'et- prefix undergoes phonological changes:

- **Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): Metathesis** — the t and the sibilant swap positions. E.g., š-m- ' → 'et-šma ' becomes 'eš-t-ma ' ܫܡܬܐ 'it was heard'; similarly 'et-z ' aq → 'ez-t- ' aq
- **Before dental/emphatic consonants (d, ṭ): Assimilation** — the t assimilates to the following consonant. E.g., d-k-y → 'et-dky becomes 'ed-dky (with doubling), sometimes written without the doubled letter.

- Before all other consonants: No change — e.g., q-t-l → 'etqtel; k-t-b → 'etkatteb

3.3 Full Paradigm: Ethpeel of q-t-l (be killed)

Perfect (all 10 forms):

PERSON / NUMBER / GENDER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtel	he was killed
3fsg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelat	she was killed
2msg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelt	you (m.sg.) were killed
2fsg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltī	you (f.sg.) were killed
1sg	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelet	I was killed
3mpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqtelw	they (m.) were killed
3fpl	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtel(n)	they (f.) were killed
2mpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltūn	you (m.pl.) were killed
2fpl	ሐሃዎሐደ	'etqteltēn	you (f.pl.) were killed
1pl	ሃዎሐደ	'etqtelan	we were killed

Participial Forms (Ethpeel Participle of q-t-l):

FORM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
Active Participle m.sg.	ሠቀሏ	metqṭel	being killed (m.sg.)
Active Participle f.sg.	ሠቀላ	metqṭelā	being killed (f.sg.)
Active Participle m.pl.	ሠቀሎ	metqṭelīn	being killed (m.pl.)
Active Participle f.pl.	ሠቀሉ	metqṭelān	being killed (f.pl.)

SECTION 4: THE ETTAPHAL AND ETPAAEL STEMS

4.1 The Ettaphal — Passive of the Aphel

The **Ettaphal** is the passive counterpart of the Aphel (causative) stem. Its formation inserts 'etta-' before the root. Since the Aphel adds the causative meaning ('to cause to X'), the Ettaphal means '**to be caused to X**' — i.e., the passive of a causative, as in 'to be saved' (from 'to save'), 'to be sent' (from 'to send').

Example 1: Root ḥ-y-y / Aphel 'aḥyī (save/give life) → Ettaphal: 'eṭḥayyī
ሠሐረ 'he was saved / given life'

Example 2: Root š-d-r / Aphel 'ašdar (send) → Ettaphal: 'ešṭadar
ሰገረ 'he was sent'

Example 3: Root ' -q-m / Aphel 'aqīm (raise up) → Ettaphal: 'ettaqam
ሠቀሐ 'he was raised up'

Full Paradigm — Ettaphal Perfect of š-d-r (be sent):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሰገረ	'eštadar	he was sent
3fsg	ሰገረት	'eštadrat	she was sent
2msg	ሰገረህ	'eštadart	you (m.sg.) were sent
1sg	ሰገረኝ	'eštaderet	I was sent
3mpl	ሰገሩ	'eštadarw	they (m.) were sent
1pl	ሰገርን	'eštadaran	we were sent

4.2 The Etpaael — Passive/Reflexive of the Paael

The **Etpaael** is the passive or reflexive of the Paael (intensive/causative) stem. Its prefix is **'etpa-**. Since the Paael often carries intensive meaning ('to bless greatly', 'to teach'), the Etpaael means **'to be blessed', 'to be taught', 'to be sanctified'**. It can also be reflexive ('to sanctify oneself').

Example 1: Root b-r-k / Paael barrek (bless) → Etpaael: **'etbarrak**

ሰገረ 'he was blessed'

Example 2: Root y-l-p / Paael yallep (teach) → Etpaael: **'etyallap** ሰገረ

'he was taught / he learned'

Example 3: Root q-d-š / Paael qaddeš (sanctify) → Etpaael: **'etqaddaš**

ሰገረ 'he was sanctified / he sanctified himself'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of b-r-k (be blessed):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	אֲבָרַךְ	'etbarrak	he was blessed
3fsg	אֲבָרַכְתְּ	'etbarkat	she was blessed
2msg	אֲבָרַכְתָּ	'etbarkart	you (m.sg.) were blessed
1sg	אֲבָרַכְתִּי	'etbarkaret	I was blessed
3mpl	אֲבָרַכּוּ	'etbarkaw	they were blessed
1pl	אֲבָרַכְנוּ	'etbarkan	we were blessed

SECTION 5: THE PASSIVE PARTICIPLE (PEAL)**5.1 Form and Usage**

Distinct from the Ethpeel, the **Peal passive participle** is a simple adjectival form expressing a **completed passive state**: 'written' (ktīb), 'killed' (qṭīl), 'bound' (' sīr). Its pattern is **CāCoC** or in vocalized manuscripts **CCīC**. It agrees in gender and number with its noun, like any adjective. It is often used in **verbless clauses** with a predicative function: *gawrā qṭīlā* אִישׁ קָטִיל = 'the man is killed / the killed man'.

Students of Arabic will recognise the **passive participle (ism al-maf' ūl)**: مَقْتُول maqtūl 'killed', مَكْتُوب maktūb 'written'. The Hebrew equivalent is **qāṭūl**: קָטִיל. The pattern is strikingly consistent across Semitic languages.

5.2 Passive Participles — Ten Key Verbs

ROOT	ESTRANGELA (M.S.G.)	TRANSLIT. (M.S.G.)	ESTRANGELA (F.S.G.)	ENGLISH MEANING
<i>k-t-b</i>	כתב	<i>ktīb</i>	כתובה <i>ktībtā</i>	written
<i>q-t-l</i>	قتל	<i>qṭīl</i>	قتולה <i>qṭīltā</i>	killed, slain
<i>'-s-r</i>	שרס	<i>'sīr</i>	שרסו <i>'sīrtā</i>	bound, imprisoned
<i>š-r-y</i>	שרי	<i>šrī</i>	שריו <i>šrīyā</i>	loosed, released
<i>š-d-r</i>	שרד	<i>šdīr</i>	שרדו <i>šdīrtā</i>	sent
<i>p-q-d</i>	פקד	<i>pqīd</i>	פקדו <i>pqīdtā</i>	commanded; commandment (noun)
<i>'-m-d</i>	מדם	<i>'mīd</i>	מדםו <i>'mīdtā</i>	baptized (lit. 'dipped')
<i>š-l-b</i>	שלב	<i>šlīb</i>	שלו <i>šlībtā</i>	crucified; also: the cross
<i>q-b-r</i>	קבר	<i>qbīr</i>	קברו <i>qbīrtā</i>	buried
<i>b-r-k</i>	ברך	<i>brīk</i>	ברכתו <i>brīktā</i>	blessed (adj.)

5.3 Passive Participle in Verbless Clauses

Examples of the passive participle used predicatively in verbless clauses:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܐܢܫܐ ܩܬܝܠܐ	<i>gawrā qṭilā</i>	man.the killed.m.sg	The man is killed.
ܝܘܚܢܢ ܥܡܝܕ	<i>Yukhannan 'sīr</i>	Yukhannan bound	Yukhannan is bound.
ܕܠܝܒܐ ܕܩܘܫܬܐ ܕܠܝܒܐ ܕܩܘܫܬܐ	<i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā</i>	book.the written in- truth	The book is written in truth.
ܡܫܝܚܐ ܒܪܝܟܐ ܠܥܠܡܐ	<i>Mšiḥā brīk l- 'ālam</i>	Messiah.the blessed forever	The Messiah is blessed forever.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS (PASSIVE FOCUS)

These 30 words are central to Lesson 10 and to Syriac Christian literature generally. Each entry includes the basic (Peal) root, an Et-stem form where relevant, and the English meaning. Many are important theological terms.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-m-d	בִּטְּחַ / בִּטְחַ	'mad / 'et 'med	baptize / to be baptized (dip, immerse)
g-l-y	גִּלְיָ / גִּלְיָ	glā / 'etglī	reveal / to be revealed, appear
h-y-y / Aph.	חַיָּי / חַיָּי	'ahyī / 'ethayyī	save, give life / to be saved
q-t-l	קָטַל / קָטַל	qṭal / 'etqṭel	kill / to be killed
'-s-r	שָׂרַר / שָׂרַר	'asar / 'et 'eser	bind / to be bound
š-r-y	שָׂרַר / שָׂרַר	šrā / 'etšrī	loosen / to be loosed, released
š-d-r	שָׂדַר / שָׂדַר	šadar / 'eštadar	send / to be sent (Ettaphal)
'-s-y	שָׂרַר / שָׂרַר	'asī / 'et 'asī	heal / to be healed
q-w-m / Aph.	קָוַם / קָוַם	'aqīm / 'ettaqam	raise up / to be raised (Ettaphal)
k-n-š	כָּנַשׁ / כָּנַשׁ	knaš / 'etkneš	gather / to be gathered
d-k-y	דָּקַי / דָּקַי	dkā / 'etdkī	purify / to be purified
š-b-q	שָׁבַח / שָׁבַח	šbaq / 'etšbaq	forgive, leave / to be forgiven
b-r-k	בָּרַךְ / בָּרַךְ	barrek / 'etbarrak	bless (Paael) / to be blessed (Etpaael)
y-l-p	יָלַח / יָלַח	yallep / 'etyallap	teach (Paael) / to be taught (Etpaael)
m-š-ḥ	מָשַׁח / מָשַׁח	mšah / 'etmšah	anoint / to be anointed
š-l-b	שָׁלַב / שָׁלַב	šlab / 'etšlab	crucify / to be crucified
q-b-r	קָבַר / קָבַר	qbar / 'etqbar	bury / to be buried
d-w-n / Aph.	דָּוַן / דָּוַן	'addīn / 'ettaddīn	judge / to be judged (Ettaphal)
h-y-b	חַיָּב / חַיָּב	ḥayyeb / 'ethayyab	condemn, make guilty / to be condemned
p-r-q	פָּרַח / פָּרַח	praq / 'etpraq	redeem, save / to be redeemed
k-l-l	כָּלַל / כָּלַל	kallel / 'etkallal	crown / to be crowned
r-w-m / Aph.	רָוַם / רָוַם	'arīm / 'etrīm	exalt / to be exalted
š-p-l	שָׁפַל / שָׁפַל	špel / 'etšpal	humiliate / to be humbled
t-r-d	תָּרַד / תָּרַד	trad / 'ettrad	cast out, expel / to be cast out

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-w-d / <i>Aph.</i>	אָדָּר, אָדָּר	' <i>awdī</i>	confess, give thanks (<i>Aphel</i>)
<i>t-w-b</i>	בָּחַל / בָּחַל	<i>tāb / tāyib</i>	return, repent; repentant (participle)
<i>y-l-d</i>	יָלַד / יָלַד	<i>yled / 'etyled</i>	give birth / to be born (<i>Ethpeel</i>)
<i>n-h-r / Aph.</i>	הִנְחִיחַ / הִנְחִיחַ	' <i>anhar / 'etnahar</i>	illuminate / to be illumined, enlightened
<i>m-l-y</i>	מָלֵא / מָלֵא	<i>mlā / 'etmlī</i>	fill / to be filled
<i>p-r-š / Aph.</i>	פָּרַשׁ / פָּרַשׁ	' <i>aprash / 'etpraš</i>	separate, distinguish / to be separated
'-h-d	הִחַד / הִחַד	' <i>aḥad / 'et 'aḥed</i>	unite / to be united
<i>ḥ-l-m</i>	חָלַם / חָלַם	<i>ḥelam / 'etḥelam</i>	dream / to be dreamed

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 10

Yukhannan Is Thrown into the Fire — and Saved

The narrative continues from Lesson 9. Yukhannan has been bound and dragged to the furnace. Now the passive voice dominates the story: things happen *to* Yukhannan — he is thrown, he is saved, the miracle is revealed to the city. The story showcases *Ethpeel*, *Ettaphal*, and passive participle forms throughout.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
וּכְחַנָּן נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	w- 'etremy Yukhannan b- 'attūnā	and-was.thrown Yukhannan into- furnace	And Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace.
וְכִי לֹא נִשְׁלַח לֵה	w-nūrā lā qrebet leh	and-fire.the not it.approached to.him	But the fire did not approach him.
כַּדְּכִי וְכַדְּכִי חֲבֵרָה שֶׁשָׁם הָיוּ חֲבֵרָיו	'ayk d- 'et 'bed 'am Ḥananyā w- ḥabrāw(hy)	as that-was.done with Hananiah and- companions-his	Just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	'ethzī gēr gabrā d- nūr b-gaw 'attūnā	was.seen for man of.fire in-midst furnace.the	For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן מִנְהָר	w-Yukhannan 'etnahar men nūhreh	and-Yukhannan was.illuminated from light-his	And Yukhannan was illuminated by his light.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	w-kad nepaq 'ethzī paršūpeh 'ayk šemšā	and-when he.went.out was.seen face-his like sun	And when he came out, his face was seen like the sun.
כָּל הָעָם נִשְׁלַח לֵה	kulleh kansā 'etknaš d-nehzē	all crowd.the was.gathered to.see	All the crowd was gathered to see.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	w-rabbā 'attā 'etyāde ' b-kulleh mdīntā	and-great sign was.made.known in- all city.the	And the great sign was made known in all the city.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	saggī 'ē dḥelw w- 'etpanīw	many they.feared and- they.turned.back	Many feared and repented.
וְכִי נִשְׁלַח בְּאֵתֵּן כִּלְבָּן	w- 'āmryn: brīk hū 'Alāhā d- Yukhannan	and-they.say: blessed is God of- Yukhannan	And they said: 'Blessed is the God of Yukhannan!'

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܡܕܢܚܝܢ ܡܨܠܡܐ ܡܨܠܡܐ ܡܨܠܡܐ	<i>w-Yukhannan</i> <i>'etpraq men 'īdī</i> <i>ba 'eldabbāw(hy)</i>	and-Yukhannan was.redeemed from hands.of enemies-his	And Yukhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies.
ܡܨܠܡܐ ܡܨܠܡܐ ܡܨܠܡܐ ܡܨܠܡܐ	<i>w-šubhā 'etyahab l-</i> <i>'Alāhā</i>	and-glory was.given to-God	And glory was given to God.

Smooth English Translation:

And Yuhannan was thrown into the furnace. But the fire did not approach him — just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions. For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace, and Yuhannan was illumined by his light. When he came out, his face was seen like the sun. All the crowd was gathered to see. And the great sign was made known in all the city. Many feared and repented. And they said: 'Blessed is the God of Yuhannan!' And Yuhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies, and glory was given to God.

Biblical Allusion: The reference to Ḥananyā and his companions (Hananiah/Shadrach — cf. Dan 3) is intentional. This is a common hagiographic motif in Syriac martyr literature: the saint re-enacts biblical miracles.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify the stem of each verb form (Peal, Paael, Aphel, Ethpeel, Etpaael, or Ettaphal) and give its basic meaning.

1. 'etq̄tel 
2. 'etbarrak 
3. 'eštadar 
4. metq̄tel 

5. 'etpraq ܐܬܦܪܩ
6. 'et' med ܐܬܡܝܕ
7. 'ettaqam ܐܬܩܡ
8. brīk ܒܪܝܬ
9. 'etnahar ܐܬܢܗܪ
10. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗ
11. 'etyallap ܐܬܝܠܠܦ
12. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗ

Exercise 2: Active to Passive Transformation

Rewrite each active sentence in the passive voice using the appropriate Et-stem. Adjust agreement as needed.

1. malkā qṭal l-gawrā — the king killed the man.
2. kāhnā barrek l- ' ammā — the priest blessed the people.
3. šadar malkā estrāṭyōṭā — the king sent the soldiers.
4. ' Ayī ' aḥyī l-ḥalīšā — the healer saved the weak man.
5. yallep rabbā tlāmīdē — the teacher taught the disciples.
6. ' aqīm l- ' mītā — he raised the dead man.

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into smooth English.

1. ܠܥܠܡ ܕܐܝܬܐ

2. אֲהַפִּיט מִן תְּחֵלְכָּךְ.
3. אֲהַלֵּךְ אִתָּךְ אֶת־כָּל־כִּסְיֶיךָ.
4. הָיָה אֲהַבֵּיב בְּמִדְבָּר.
5. מָצָא אֲהַלֵּיב אֶת־הַסֶּבֶז.
6. אֲהַלֵּךְ בָּךְ אֶת־הַלֵּל.
7. מִן מִלְּךְ מִלְּךְ מִלְּךְ.
8. אֲהַבֵּיב מִלְּךְ בְּךְ אֲהִי.

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Write each sentence in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

1. He was baptized in the river.
2. The soldiers were sent to the city.
3. The dead man was raised.
4. She was healed by the saint.
5. The word of God was heard in all the land.
6. He was crowned by the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following questions in English.

1. What happened when Yikhannan was thrown into the furnace?
2. What was the biblical parallel mentioned in the story?

3. What was seen in the midst of the furnace?
4. How did the people of the city respond to the miracle?
5. What phrase do the people use to glorify God? Translate it word for word.

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

1. 'etq̄tel — Ethpeel (passive of Peal) — 'he was killed'
2. 'etbarrak — Etpaael (passive/reflexive of Paael) — 'he was blessed'
3. 'eštadar — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel) — 'he was sent'; note metathesis of t after š
4. metq̄tel — Ethpeel participle — 'being killed'
5. 'etpraq — Ethpeel — 'he was redeemed/saved'
6. 'et' med — Ethpeel — 'he was baptized'
7. 'ettaqam — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel 'aqīm) — 'he was raised'
8. brīk — Peal passive participle — 'blessed' (adjective)
9. 'etnahar — Ettaphal or Ethpeel (depending on analysis of root) — 'he was illumined'
10. 'etmšah — Ethpeel — 'he was anointed'
11. 'etyallap — Etpaael (passive of Paael yallep) — 'he was taught / he learned'
12. (Same as #10 — intentional duplicate for review; answer same)

Exercise 2: Active to Passive

1. 'etq̄tel gawrā (l-malkā) — The man was killed (by the king).
2. 'etbarrak 'ammā (l-kāhnā) — The people were blessed (by the priest).
3. 'eštadrw estrātyōṭā — The soldiers were sent.
4. 'eṭhayyī ḥališā — The weak man was saved.
5. 'etyalpw tlāmīdē — The disciples were taught.
6. 'ettaqam 'mītā — The dead man was raised.

Exercise 3: Translation

1. He was thrown into the fire.
2. He was saved/redeemed from (his) enemies.
3. The light was revealed in the darkness.
4. The crowd was gathered in the city.
5. The Messiah was crucified and buried.
6. The Son of God was born.
7. He is killed / he was killed on account of our sins.
8. His voice was heard in every place.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. אֶת־מֶד בִּנְהָרָא 'et 'med b-nahrā
2. אֶשְׁתַּדְרַו עֲסֵרָתְיֹוֹתַי לַמְּדִינָה 'eštadrw estrātyōṭē l-mdīntā

3. ܐܬܩܡ ܡܝܬܐ ' ettaqam mītā
4. ܐܬܐܣܝܬ ܡܢ ܩܕܕܝܫܐ ' et ' asīt men qaddīšā (f.)
5. ܐܬܡܬܐ ܕܠܐܗܐ ܒܠܐܝܬܐ ' eštma ' maltā d- ' Alāhā
b-kullā ar ' ā
6. ܐܬܟܠܐ ܡܢ ܡܠܟܐ ' etkallal men malkā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

1. The fire did not approach him — he was unharmed.
2. Hananiah (Shadrach) and his companions in the fiery furnace (Daniel 3).
3. A man of fire (an angelic figure) was seen in the midst of the furnace.
4. Many feared and repented, and said 'Blessed is the God of Yuxhannan!'
5. 'Brīk hū ' Alāhā d-Yuxhannan' — Blessed (is) he, the God of Yuxhannan. Word-for-word: brīk = blessed; hū = he (is); ' Alāhā = God.the; d- = of; Yuxhannan = Yuxhannan.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

Complete Table of All Six Syriac Verbal Stems

This is the master reference table for all six Syriac stems. Memorise the patterns, the characteristic prefixes, and the cross-linguistic equivalents.

STEM	PERF. 3MSG	PARTICIPLE	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Peal ܩܬܠ	qṭal ܩܬܠ	qāṭel ܩܬܠ	(none)	Basic active: 'he killed'
Paael ܩܬܠܐ	qattal ܩܬܠܐ	mqattal ܩܬܠܐܐ	doubling	Intensive / denominative: 'he slew repeatedly / he executed'
Aphel ܩܬܠܐ	ʾaqtel ܩܬܠܐ	maqtel ܩܬܠܐܐ	ʾa-	Causative: 'he caused to kill'
Ethpeel ܩܬܠܐܐ	ʾetqtel ܩܬܠܐܐ	metqtel ܩܬܠܐܐܐ	ʾet-	Passive/reflexive of Peal: 'he was killed'
Etpaael ܩܬܠܐܐܐ	ʾetqattal ܩܬܠܐܐܐ	metqattal ܩܬܠܐܐܐܐ	ʾetpa-	Passive/reflexive of Paael: 'he was executed'
Ettaphal ܩܬܠܐܐܐܐ	ʾettaqtel ܩܬܠܐܐܐܐܐ	mettaqtel ܩܬܠܐܐܐܐܐܐ	ʾetta-	Passive of Aphel: 'he was caused to be killed'

Passive Participle Pattern

+-----+

Peal Passive Participle |

|

Pattern: CCīC (or CāCoC in some vocalization traditions) |

|

Agrees in gender and number with noun (like any adjective) |

|

m.sg.: ktīb ܟܬܒܐ | f.sg.: ktībtā ܟܬܒܬܐ | m.pl.: ktībīn ܟܬܒܝܢ | f.pl.: |

ktībān ܟܬܒܐܢ |

|

Used predicatively in verbless clauses: gawrā qṭīlā = 'the man is killed' |

|

Compare: Arabic maf' ūl (مَكْتُوب maktūb 'written'); Hebrew qāṭūl (קָטוּל) |

+-----+

Ethpeel Phonological Rules

+-----+

Assimilation & Metathesis in Ethpeel |

|

Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): METATHESIS — t moves after the |
sibilant |

|

'et- + š-m- ' → 'eštma' (not * 'etšma') |

|

Before dentals (d, ṭ): ASSIMILATION — t assimilates to the |
following letter |

|

'et- + d-k-y → 'eddkī |

|

Before all other consonants: no change — 'et- + q-t-l → 'etqṭel |

+-----+

*The Acts of Mar Yukhannan • Lesson 10: The Passive Voice • Syriac Language
Course*

Section 11: Additional Vocabulary

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
קְרִיתָא	qrītā	f	village
לֶשָׁנָא	leššānā	m	tongue, language
קֶמֶץ	garmā	m	bone
קֶפֶא	kēpā	f	stone, rock
מַיָּא	mayyā	m.pl	water
נִינָא	nūnā	m	fish
מְדִיתָא	mdittā	f	city
שֶׁמֶשׂא	šemšā	m	sun
תַּרְיָא	tar ‘ ā	m	door, gate
מֵשְׁחָא	mešḥā	m	oil